



SOP drafting workflow.

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE — AUTOMATION

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Department	Automation
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1. Purpose

This SOP describes how to draft a new internal SOP using the AI-assisted workflow. The workflow takes a screen-recorded transcript and screenshots as inputs and produces a branded, editable Word document that can be reviewed, refined, and published as a final PDF.

2. Scope

Applies to anyone at DSS Distro creating a new SOP, policy, or handoff document. Out of scope: editing existing approved documents (handled directly in SharePoint with version control), and external-facing documents intended for customers or suppliers.

3. Definitions

- **Transcript** — a Word document containing the auto-transcribed narration of a screen recording. Generated by iOS Voice Memos or an equivalent tool.
- **Action screenshot** — a screen capture showing a specific step in the process being documented. Named to reference the action it shows.
- **Status channel** — the DSS Automation channel in Microsoft Teams. Posts automated notifications when an SOP submission is received and when the draft is ready.
- **AI workspace** — the SharePoint folder structure where SOP drafts live during review and approval. Located in Data Hub > 06 AI Workspace.

4. Roles and responsibilities

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY
Process Owner	Records the screen capture and narration, prepares screenshots, and submits the package by email. Reviews and approves the generated draft.
Operations Owner	Final sign-off on any SOP affecting cross-department processes. Approves exceptions and resolves disagreements on content.
Automation Platform	Receives email submissions, generates the draft .docx, posts status notifications, watches for approval, converts approved drafts to PDF, publishes the final file.

5. Prerequisites

- DSS email account with access to send to claudio@digitalsmokesupplies.com.
- Membership in the DSS Automation channel on Microsoft Teams.
- Access to the Data Hub SharePoint site, specifically the 06 AI Workspace folder.
- An iPhone with iOS 18 or later for Voice Memos with auto-transcription. Screenshot capability on whatever device is being used to perform the process.

6. Step-by-step procedure

The full cycle from submission to published PDF takes roughly 10 to 30 minutes of active work, plus automation processing time between steps.

6.1 Capture the process

1. Identify the process to be documented and walk through it once end to end before recording the narration, to confirm you have all the access and tools you need.
2. On your iPhone, open **Voice Memos** and start a new recording. Voice Memos auto-transcribes on iOS 18 and later.
3. Walk through the process while narrating each step out loud. Cover what you click, why you click it, what to look for in the result, and any exceptions or judgement calls you make as you go.
4. As you complete each step, take a screenshot of the relevant screen. Name each screenshot to describe the action it shows, prefixed with a sequence number. Example:
01_open_erply_sales.png, 02_select_international_customers.png, 03_run_item_sales_by_product.png.
5. Stop the recording when the process is complete. Export the Voice Memo transcription as a Word document.
6. Save the transcript and all screenshots in a single folder on your computer.

6.2 Submit by email

1. Compose a new email to **claudio@digitalsmokesupplies.com**.
2. The subject line must start with **SOP** followed by the department and the topic, separated by hyphens. Example: **SOP - Operations - Flavour ingredient ordering**.
3. Leave the email body empty. The automation reads the transcript and screenshots only — anything in the body is ignored.
4. Attach the transcript Word document and all action screenshots. Do not zip them — attach as individual files.
5. Send the email.

6.3 Watch for the receipt notification

Within a few minutes of sending, a notification will post in the DSS Automation channel on Teams confirming the submission was received and draft generation has started. Wait for the second notification before checking SharePoint.

6.4 Review the draft

1. When the second notification posts (draft ready), open the SharePoint link from the notification or navigate to **Data Hub > 06 AI Workspace > Review SOP draft**.
2. Open the .docx file. Read it through end to end, comparing against your original transcript and the actual process.
3. Make corrections directly in the Word document. Common edits: fixing inferred details (timelines, thresholds, role names), adding missing exceptions, tightening unclear language.
4. Verify the screenshots are placed at the correct steps and the captions accurately describe each one.
5. Save the file in place. Do not rename it — the automation tracks files by name.

6.5 Approve and publish

1. Once you are satisfied with the draft, move the file from **06 AI Workspace > Review SOP draft** to **06 AI Workspace > Approved > SOP drafts**.
2. The automation detects the move, converts the .docx to PDF, publishes the PDF to its final location, and posts a confirmation notification in the status channel.
3. After publication, the .docx remains in the Approved > SOP drafts folder as the source of truth for any future revisions.

7. Status notifications reference

WHEN YOU SEE THIS	IT MEANS	YOUR NEXT STEP
SOP submission received	Email and attachments arrived; draft generation has started.	Wait for the next notification.
SOP draft ready	Word draft is in the Review SOP draft folder.	Open the file in SharePoint and

		review.
SOP published	Approved Word file has been converted to PDF and published.	No action required. Share the published PDF link as needed.
SOP submission failed	The automation could not process the email. Common causes: missing attachments, unreadable transcript format.	Resubmit with corrected attachments.

8. Folder reference

STAGE	LOCATION
Submission	Email to claudio@digitalsmokesupplies.com
Review	Data Hub > 06 AI Workspace > Review SOP draft
Approval	Data Hub > 06 AI Workspace > Approved > SOP drafts
Final published PDF	Data Hub > 04 Operation_SOPs

9. Troubleshooting

- **No receipt notification appears within 10 minutes.** Check that the email was sent to the correct address and that all attachments uploaded successfully. If the email is in your Sent folder and the notification still has not posted, contact the Operations Owner.
- **Draft is missing key steps.** The transcript was likely incomplete or the audio was unclear. Re-record the missing portion and submit a follow-up email referencing the original submission, or edit the draft directly in SharePoint.
- **Screenshots are placed at the wrong steps.** The automation matches screenshots to steps using the filename. Rename the screenshots descriptively and resubmit, or move them to the correct position directly in the Word draft.
- **File cannot be moved out of Review SOP draft.** Confirm you have edit permissions on the 06 AI Workspace folder. Contact the Operations Owner if access needs to be granted.
- **Published PDF does not appear after approval.** Check that the file was moved — not copied — to the Approved > SOP drafts folder. The automation only triggers on a move, not on a duplicate.

Non-Compliance

Skipping the review step and approving a draft without reading it produces documents that may contain inferred, inaccurate, or incomplete information. Submitting incomplete transcripts produces drafts that are missing critical steps and may mislead the next person who follows the SOP. Bypassing the approval folder — for example, manually publishing a draft to the final location — breaks the version control chain and leaves the source of truth in an undefined state.

Exceptions

Urgent SOPs that cannot wait for the full review cycle may be drafted directly in Word using the dss-sop-policy template, with Operations Owner sign-off recorded by email. The resulting file should still be placed in the Approved > SOP drafts folder so it is captured in the published location and follows the same versioning thereafter.